

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Robin Banks

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Robin Banks

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Your other secret

You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Conversations to start

- Ask Mona Lott what the museum owes people represented in its collection.
- Ask Barb Dwyer what protest would get you removed from tonight's event.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*
- 2 *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*
- 3 *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*



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Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The stickers were mine. PROVENANCE IS A VERB fits nicely in a brochure that treats ownership as a permanent noun. Grant had me removed from an earlier event and threatened legal action tonight. I came to make the collection's history visible. He wanted me visible only on a security notice.

IF MURDERER

I planted the stickers because another polite letter had accomplished nothing. Grant threatened to have me removed again before the unveiling. He would announce permanent ownership while the people asking questions waited outside. A gala was becoming another ceremony of possession.



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Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.

IF MURDERER

I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.



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Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The brochure's printer kept my artwork and the order for the protest stickers. The disputed object and its claimant are named on the back. I distributed the brochures before Grant demanded his copy destroyed. Those surviving copies explain the argument and establish which questions I brought to the museum.

IF MURDERER

Grant tore the sticker off his jacket. I wanted the protest in the toast photograph anyway. I picked up his empty glass in the salon, pressed another sticker onto its base and set it back at his place. I still had the brochures under my arm; other guests had already taken copies. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my brochure. I had that brochure with me on the preparation walkthrough and when I handled the glass. I had promised not to interfere with the presentation. I broke that promise again.



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Robin Banks

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Robin Banks

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I put the sticker on his jacket and returned after promising to stay out of the presentation. The printer kept the brochure artwork. I did not poison him. I will answer for breaking that promise and give the claimant the files. Grant's death does not turn disputed possession into permanent ownership.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. The sticker was my excuse for picking it up. A fragment of the bottle's custody band caught in my brochure; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and my account placed me at both objects. He wanted me removed before announcing permanent ownership. I murdered him in the museum whose history I wanted corrected.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.